

PULSATION OF CONSCIOUSNESS

Greetings, my dearest, dearest friends. Blessings for this entire coming working season, not only for this hour but for all the subsequent efforts, endeavors, and steps on your path, which must lead to finding home -- provided these efforts are sincere and whole. Home means your real, innermost true self. He who is his real self is at home. At home in the world, at home in life, safe and secure with a firmly established ground under his feet. At home means the inner place where all problems find their solution, where no fear and hate exist. When fear exists, hate must exist, and vice versa. They are really one and the same. At home is the inner place where eternal well-being and eternal life are reality, experienced as a fact.

First, eternal life is relative. Gradually it becomes absolute. Relative eternal life may seem like a contradiction, an absurdity. Yet, eternal life in the absolute cannot reveal itself in one sudden manifestation. It reveals itself gradually, as the consciousness expands and as time expands, from one dimension to the other. Within three-dimensional time itself, the sense of eternity grows, life itself expands -- not only in the sense that the healthier and more whole a person becomes, the more the duration of his life expands, but also in the inner sense and experience of it. But about this we shall talk another time.

Every fall, when we start a new working season, the first lecture sets the pace and the stage, so to speak. It heralds the emphasis of our concern as an overall picture, the necessary repetitions notwithstanding. It represents a blueprint of the future work, and it must be, at the same time, the natural continuation of where we left off. Thus this lecture will be simultaneously the sequence of what has passed and the foreshadowing of what is to come, that is, if you study it sensitively. The topic of it is pulsation of consciousness.

Everyone knows that all living organisms pulsate and breathe and move. But strangely enough these qualities are primarily ascribed to the physical manifestations of life and are ignored as far as consciousness is concerned. Yet identical laws must prevail for both. Let me briefly enumerate certain basic aspects about pulsation. Everything that lives must pulsate, as it must breathe and move. Therefore pulsation and breathing are interrelated. The movement of life is contained in both. The movement is involuntary and occurs in rhythmic intervals, provided the organism is healthy, harmonious, undisturbed. Think, for example, of the heartbeat of the healthy person. It is very regular and rhythmic. A sick or a disturbed and fearful heart automatically loses this rhythmic quality. Everything healthy moves and pulsates rhythmically. On the physical level, this rhythm occurs according to that dimension of time which applies to all physical manifestation. This is three-dimensional time. For the three-dimensionally oriented observation, the rhythmic movement is regular in intervals. The pulsebeat can be measured according to three-dimensional time.

The involuntary movements take place according to the three principles outlined a while back, namely the expanding, the restricting, and the static principles. Everything that lives must follow these principles. Breath and pulsation very obviously demonstrate this truth. All this is demonstrable on the physical level. The identical laws apply to the level of consciousness although there they are less obvious. It requires a certain amount of tuning in on the soul movements and the inner reality of the self to realize these laws, to experience them. First it is a sensing and intuitive knowing until it becomes as definite and factual an experience as any "outer" fact of life.

When consciousness is harmonious and in accordance with the universal laws, the rhythm occurs regularly. The dimension of consciousness is not three-dimensional, as the physical organism is. The emotional or mental or spiritual organism belongs to another dimension. Therefore its rhythmic nature does not seem to have the same kind of regularity in its intervals as the physical pulsations do. To the three-dimensionally oriented perception, the pulsations or cycles of consciousness do not appear rhythmic. They appear irregular and haphazard. The expansion cycle, for example, may be longer or shorter than the restricting cycle. Or one expansion cycle may last longer than the next. Yet, according to this other dimension, such may be a lawful, regular, harmonious movement. It is meaningful within its own inner law and can only be understood in terms of the individual consciousness and of those aspects of the consciousness which each particular movement expresses and signifies.

In other words, the pulsation of consciousness expresses the state of consciousness of any given moment, the degree of self-realization and growth, or their lack. It expresses the particular meaning where growth is most needed, where it may be overemphasized at the price of neglect in other areas. The experience of each individual is, as you already know, a result of his innermost beliefs, concepts, attitudes, feelings, and actions. How each experience is met also determines the rhythm of pulsation. People are often aware of phases, or cycles, in their lives. They feel they have "good times" and "bad times." They even sense occasionally that certain periods tend more in one direction and concentrate more on certain aspects of living, while at other periods different emphases may be quite obvious. These manifestations are, of course, aspects of the pulsation of consciousness. But they do not appear in regularly spaced intervals as do the physical pulsations of the organism. However, when a person is very perceptive, very intuitive, and very finely attuned to the inner reality as result of considerable self-knowledge and development, he clearly senses that these irregular phases are not chaotic or arbitrary. They, too, follow a certain order although its nature may still be obscure.

Let us now try to understand what the expansion, the restriction, and the static principles mean in terms of the pulsating movement of consciousness. The movement of expansion expresses reaching out; the restricting movement means bringing or gathering into the organism; the static movement means assimilation of both and the transition from one to the other. I discussed this more in detail several years ago. The significance of this threefold principle in regard to the living, breathing, pulsating universe, in all its aspects, is very important.

In the healthy organism, the changing from one to the other of these three movements occurs, as stated, regularly and meaningfully. The spiritual significance is always growth, completion, perfection, additional creation, pleasure supreme. For growth and pleasure are one. The one cannot exist without the other. In organic growth, expansion represents the direct expression of

development, while the restricting and static movement indirectly further it through assimilation, digestion, utilization of what was gained, rest.

In the disturbed organism, distorted by misconceptions, the expanding movement appears fraught with danger. Misconception must always lead to resistance to growth. The disturbed organism is in fear. And fear makes expansion appear painful and threatening. Fear contracts in unpleasure. Hence, the disturbed organism unpleasurably contracts when it should pleasurably expand. And when the natural contracting movement is supposed to set in, in rhythmic change, it cannot do so since it already is cramped, hardened, and so exaggeratedly contracted that pulsating life movement becomes impossible.

All outer, or apparently outer, experience coming to man is, as we know, really self-produced. It is a reflection of what already exists within. It could not come his way from without if it were not there within his own consciousness first. For the person who is disconnected from his unconscious, this seems at best theoretical and all too metaphysical. For him who explores and discovers the mechanisms and the reality of his own unconscious, and can therefore identify and connect with it, what I say here is experienced as undisputable fact.

When negative outer experience comes to him who has not connected with that part of his innermost self that has produced it, the experience is rejected, withdrawn from, cringed away from. The organism cramps up in a movement of fear away from that which seems alien and as having nothing to do with it. But since, in reality, the undesirable outer experience is an aspect of an existing condition within, fighting against it amounts to fighting against the self. It is therefore completely opposed to the law of growth to restrict the pulsation of consciousness by hardening up and refusing the experience. I shall explain the meaningful and adequate reaction in a moment.

This apparently theoretical discussion, my friends, is not half as theoretical as it may appear on the surface. I will show you how you can immediately and very practically apply this to exactly where you are on your path at this moment, provided you pay attention to your soul movements, provided you focus your attention, your awareness, on your emotions and soul movements. The previous years of work must have made you aware, to some extent at least, what you feel at any given moment. You register when you cramp up in fear, for example. I discussed the matter of soul movement again and again. Unfortunately, most people are not even aware that such a thing exists. But with a little observation and turning inwards, observing the distinct movements of your psyche, you will become acutely aware of their existence, of their meaning. You will see, for example, the tremendous difference of soul movements when you are in harmony with yourself, when you feel that all is right between yourself and life. These soul movements fill you with a wonderful, subtle but distinct movement that is vibrant, pleasurable, harmonious. You can feel yourself expand toward the outer world, your whole inner organism reaching out fearlessly and pleasurably, even when the outer experience is doubtful and not necessarily desirable. This fearless meeting of it enables you to transcend the experience, to truly assimilate it. In that way, the threat soon vanishes. The restricting movement does not cramp up and congest. It remains organic. During the inward movement, the consciousness, on its deepest levels, corrects the misconceptions that have brought about the outer unwelcome experience. Through not cringing away on the outgoing pulsebeat and meeting what appears first as pain, the ingathering movement may first intensify this pain. But soon, if it is truly met, it reduces itself naturally, and on the next outgoing beat, the waste (misconception, fear) is expelled -- just as the physical organism expels waste through the pulsating

blood and heartbeat. Soon the following movements are in pleasure where they were first in pain. The safety and pleasure cannot be gained when the spiritual pulsebeat is stopped through hardening, through refusal of the experience, through unnatural restriction.

The better you are attuned to your inner path, the clearer you will see how each phase of your life means something in terms of your evolution. Each phase concentrates on certain aspects of your being. And each difficulty and hardship requests something from you. It contains a distinct message -- coming from your own real self. How soon are you going to understand this message and learn what you have to learn? How soon will you decide to go through it in pulsating openness of your psyche rather than attempting to go around? The latter is stark illusion, for meeting the difficulty cannot really be avoided. It must reappear in different forms until you have healed your spiritual organism from its afflictions. Fleeing the experience that seems painful, undesirable, dangerous is fleeing from yourself, just as fighting it means fighting yourself. Giving in to the fear of the experience makes you refuse the experience. Since the experience is a result of yourself, your refusal of it amounts to refusing yourself. Psychologically, this refusal manifests in denial of happiness and pleasure. This is why it is so true that only he who can stand pain can in exact measure stand pleasure.

No matter how much theoretical understanding you may already possess about the principle and truth of the outer life being nothing more or less than a reflection of your inner state of consciousness, it means little if you still shy away from going through the experience. Jesus expressed the same with the words, "Do not resist evil." This sentence can, of course, like everything else, be easily misinterpreted and distorted. The evil is nothing else but deeply lodged misconceptions with their inevitable further result: fear, guilt, anger, hate, greed, cruelty, selfishness, destructiveness of self and others -- of life. All the negativity in the world stems from something one believes in that is not according to reality. No matter what the negative event in one's private life may be, it must be caused from within, from an inner wrong idea according to which one functions, moves, lives, responds, and reacts. I might almost equate the illusion of separateness between your outer and your inner life with an "optical illusion." Hence, nothing could be greater folly and a greater act of warfare against yourself than fleeing from experience that comes to you apparently disconnected from yourself.

The only way to go about it is to go into the experience. In terms of pulsation of consciousness, the following procedure is indicated and most highly rewarding. When anything happens to you that you shrink back from, whether it causes mild annoyance or stark fright or anything in between, remain inwardly relaxed. Observe the automatic reflex reaction in your soul movement, how it automatically tenses up. By remaining open and relaxed to the experience, no matter how painful or frightening it may appear, you allow it to happen to you. You thus admit that it is yours anyway, and you proceed to find its origin in you. You declare in your mind to explore and understand its cause. And you also live up to this "declaration" with your emotional self by allowing the healthy pulsebeat of the psyche to continue its natural process. Thus you remain in an open state that enables you to comprehend and to respond in an infinitely more adequate way than when you are in a tense state of war and defense.

This seems to require a great deal of trust in life, the universe, others, and your own innermost self. For by remaining relaxed and undefended in your soul substance, by allowing the flexible movements of natural pulsation to continue, you seem exposed to danger. But is it not stark illusion

to suppose that this unnatural, evasive way of self-defense is a more trustworthy protection than the way I suggest here? The point could be argued at length, but the best course is to take a chance and find out. You are bound to discover the truth of these words. You will see how what seemed at first like dire threat or unbearable pain to be avoided at all cost, soon turns into profound enlightenment, safety, well-being. You will feel your entire inner and outer organism vibrantly alive and growing.

When the restricting, tense, congested movement pulls in automatically where it should remain vibrantly pulsating, its meaning can be translated into words. They are, "I do not want this experience." This presupposes that the experience has nothing to do with causes within yourself. It presupposes that others, circumstances, chance have brought this experience to you. Therefore whenever you detect the shrinking back movement of your soul currents, you know that on that level you ignore the connection between outer and inner reality. You also know, at this moment, that you live in an illusion, and all illusion breeds pain. The painful experience you wish to avoid by interrupting your natural spiritual pulsebeat rests on just such an illusion. By refusing what is yours (good or bad), your mentality denies the self-responsibility for the unwelcome experience, and your emotions disturb the natural rhythm of the pulsation of your entire organism. It amounts to a deliberate stopping of breathing and pulsebeat through some artificial, unorganic means.

Again I would like to point out how parallel these laws are for the spiritual and physical levels of man. What I explained about the advisable approach to the healing of your disturbed psyche applies in exactly the same way to the physical body. As the soul movements should remain untensed, open, relaxed regardless of disturbances, in order to eliminate these disturbances in a real way, so should the body be treated. Assume someone has a damaged heart. Would he cure this ailment if he shrinks back from this fact in tension, fright, and contraction? -- certainly not. He would not only make it worse, in this movement or reaction he expresses his refusal of the fact that he has acquired a damaged heart. The only way to correct the damage is to relax what has unduly been tensed up. For that purpose, a full acceptance of his condition is inevitable. Even purely chemical medication attempts to artificially loosen up the cramp and reestablish an easy, smooth, vibrant, flexible pulsation. To think of such comparison between the physical and psychic levels will be quite helpful. It will give you an idea of the unification of creation and make what I say here more practicable.

When you attempt to put into practice what I advise here, it will first seem quite risky to remain undefended and relaxed inside when something threatens you. Needless to say, I am talking here about psychological reactions, outer experiences that cause negative, destructive emotions and reactions in you. I do not mean the occasional physical threats outside. There, the quickening defensive tightening is automatic and healthy. But it lasts only a very short time, and it is the exception. If a condition reoccurs regularly in your life, this is an altogether different story. In these instances, when you fear and notice the shrinking back of the restricting movement, try to remain open. Let the inner movements occur in their own natural way, uninfluenced by this fearful level of your consciousness. Allow the natural organism to continue without interfering with the pulsation of expansion, restriction, and static movements. The natural restricting movement will open up by itself. It will carry you quite naturally into the next organic expanding movement. You will distinctly experience how what was painful on the first pulsebeat of expansion diminishes with each pulsebeat. Each set of movements will expand your self-realization, your grasp of your own inner truth as it relates to the event in question. It will fill you with peace, well-being, safety, and pleasure.

Each outgoing movement will increase this positive condition. Let it happen from within, just as you must let the physical pulsation happen without interference by a fearful, distrusting attitude. Cooperate with this inner lawfulness by simply wanting to see the truth in you.

I recapitulate, observe your soul movements. Understand their meaning. Allow them to function naturally. Do not let fear cramp up the natural pulsation. Let the involuntary, self-regulating lawfulness establish harmony within by not interfering with fear and resistance. Simultaneously, cooperate with your whole being, with all your sincerity and integrity in your willingness to see the truth in you, in wanting to understand the connections between yourself and the unwelcome emotions and those outer conditions that cause these emotions. Do this ego cooperation in a firm, relaxed way. Relaxation must be combined with full commitment. Often, tension replaces a lack of such full commitment to the inner truth.

Let yourself vibrate without defending your soul substance even though it may seem risky. It appears as if you were thus too vulnerable and exposed. But this is not true. It merely reestablishes the healthy heartbeat of your psyche. It does not mean that you invite damaging, destructive actions from others or yourself. Quite the contrary is true. Healthy self-assertion can only happen when you are not cramped up inside, when your natural pulsebeat functions according to its own organic law.

My friends, as I said before, this material is not difficult or abstract for those who already explored their innermost self to some extent or for those who take in these words with all their attention. If you fully think about these words and apply them to yourself, you will see how immediately practicable they are. Look at what you really feel. See what fear and pain and guilt and anger make you do within, how you contract. Observe these soul movements. From there on, it will become quite obvious that all is as I say here.

By shrinking from the undesirable condition or experience, the entity hopes to avoid and refuse it, thereby avoiding and refusing itself, as it were. This causes a hard, bitter, twisted pain because the way to meet it is unorganic and utterly futile. When you meet openly the condition or experience in the manner discussed, at first it will be a pain too. But the pain will have a completely different characteristic. It will soon turn into a softness that can dissolve much easier. It will transform itself into meaningfulness and sense. It is a growing pain, not a death pain. It is a pain that creates more and better life and thus eventually transforms itself into pleasure. The energy contained in the emotion can find back to its original essence.

When you remain truthfully open to the pain or fear or other destructive emotion, you will neither masochistically aggrandize and exaggerate it, nor will you deny it -- either in self-delusion that it does not exist or in a refusal to meet it by pulling away from it. You will simply go through it and thus reconvert it to its original nature of bliss.

It always seems to require such an enormous amount of courage to do this. But that too is illusion, my friends, because it actually requires infinitely more "courage" in a wrong and futile sense to go through all the unnecessary pain of avoidance and flight. The effort to shrink back from yourself and from what you have produced in inner and outer conditions is so much more strenuous than the effort of the course I show you here.

When pursuing this course, the pain must become bliss because you have transcended it instead of fleeing from it, because you have understood its deep significance in terms of your personal growth. Thereby you allowed it to remain in its natural healthy rhythm, even with the experience that is caused by error, illusion, and unhealth. This is the only way health, security, and well-being can be reestablished.

In the time until now, we have concentrated considerably on the mental activity involved in your search for your true self, in the search for your misconceptions, and in observation of your mental and emotional processes. Even the observation of emotions was done with a more mental approach. In the time to come, with various new approaches on this path some of you begin to experience (which might be summed up briefly as a combination of the metaphysical and the physical), you will learn to feel and observe the soul movements better than ever before. These soul movements with their innate, inbuilt rhythm and lawfulness determine your entire life. They determine your state of being, your state of consciousness, your freedom or enslavement to your images and misconceptions. They determine the depth and scope and nature of your experiences in life, the degree of aliveness and pleasure, your body structure, and your fulfillment and abundance on all levels of being. The soul movements are the heartbeat of the spirit.

Now are there any questions regarding this topic?

QUESTION: What kind of experience do you mean? What if someone offers me a trip with LSD? Would you advise to go through with it just for the sake of the experience?

ANSWER: No, certainly not, nothing of the sort. I do not mean that a person should do anything and everything. This would be completely destructive and would be a crass misunderstanding of what I am talking about. A human being must exert discrimination and choice. He has the freedom to choose certain experiences or to reject them. I now discuss the principle of this question and not the matter of LSD, whether or not it is advisable. This I have already discussed some time ago, and I do not see any need to repeat it now.

What I do mean in this lecture is the experience of events, conditions, and emotions one cannot choose. They come. A recurrent condition elicits again and again difficulty, crisis, disharmony, destructive feelings. It is these experiences man so often refuses, denies, flees from when they are nothing but an expression of something in himself that he overlooks. As long as he prefers to overlook it, it must reoccur with reliable regularity, of that you can be sure.

QUESTION: There are two experiences that come to my mind. One is orgasm, the other is death. I was wondering that the pulsation and vibration seem to lead you to a point where these vibrations and pulsations cease. In both, there seems to be no more vibration and pulsation.

ANSWER: It is an illusion that they cease. Of course, this illusion is much more difficult to establish about death because your three-dimensional orientation and perception is not geared to see that it is an illusion. It merely sees the physical level, and that has indeed stopped living, vibrating, pulsating. It is unequipped to observe the consciousness behind the physical system, where living, breathing, pulsating, vibrating, and therefore thinking, feeling, being go on and on.

As far as orgasm is concerned, it is certainly an illusion that pulsation or vibration stop. This is what I said at the beginning of the lecture. When the rhythmic manifestation of pulsation is not observable to the three-dimensional perception, the pulsation of various levels of consciousness is geared to different laws. Only when you become very attuned to your innermost self will you perceive these manifestations. There is nothing on the three-dimensional level that you cannot and will not experience by a further expansion of consciousness and different dimension -- whether or not this occurs in a state of physical death or while being in the body. In fact, more, not less, can be experienced, nay must be experienced, as the being expands and grows into further dimensions. The truth of these words will become accessible right in this life when you do not cramp up against fearful experience, but allow your innermost soul movement to continue to pulsate into the experience you wanted to deny.

As you all know from our work together, this fear of experience does not only exist regarding negative, painful experience, but just as much, and often more so, regarding the most positive, desirable, and desired experiences in the universe. Utter bliss, pleasure supreme, is feared to the extent pain is denied. He who can accept pain, can endure pleasure. The two experiences you mentioned -- death and orgasm -- are the deepest experiences a created entity can go through. They are that because the ego relinquishes its hold and the individual surrenders to the cosmic, universal forces -- in love and in trust. True orgasm is not possible unless this attitude exists. And healthy death also occurs only in this inner attitude. It then becomes a joyful, growing experience. It is easily observable that the healthier a human being is, the less he fears this total, trustful surrender. Such an individual experiences the greatest amount of bliss. And also, such an individual does not fear death.

I repeat, the ability to stand pleasure, delight, ecstasy depends on the ability to assimilate in an appropriate and truthful way pain and frustration, in the understanding that they are the production of the self. To put the same idea in different words, if you can meet your own negativity, your fears, your anger, your rage, the traits you do not like, in a rational and unexaggerated way, really meet them face to face and understand them, then you produce the condition I discussed. To that measure, you become capable of experiencing delight, pleasure, happiness. There is a direct relationship between the two. You will invariably see that the person who cannot accept pain in a healthy, constructive, and realistic way cannot accept pleasure either.

I shall be glad to answer more questions on this topic, as well as on any problems you may have, at our next meeting. Be blessed, all of you. May every one of you start this working season with a new approach to your path, to your blocks that prevent and separate you from life. Dip deep into that reality of the divine within yourself, to strengthen you in your determination to grow, to unfold, to expand, to unify, to correct the areas that block you from life, from all that is good. Let guidance come from within you to help you realize the futility, the unnecessary waste of resisting this growth. And may you become more and more attuned to these inner soul movements and thereby help to reestablish the beautiful cosmic balance. This will also affect the availability of the divine in you, with which you can then integrate and establish your full, independent selfhood. Be blessed, all of you. Be in peace, be in God!

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